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Date: 12 Nov 2026

21LEM202T — Unit 4, Session 7, SLO 1

Activity B1

Classify each problem under the correct relationship.

Write each item in the correct column: human–human relationship or human–rest-of-nature relationship.

Items: Depression • Atmospheric carbon (CO_2) • Suicide • Water insecurity • Terrorism • Soil fertility • Divorce • Food insecurity • War • Climate change • Population • Genetic manipulation for profit

Human–human relationship	Human–rest of nature relationship
Depression	Atmospheric carbon (CO_2)
Suicide	Water insecurity
Terrorism	Soil fertility
Divorce	Food insecurity
War	Climate change
Population	Genetic manipulation for profit

Activity B2

Fill in the figures from the slides.

Statement	Your answer
Over the last 650,000 years CO_2 stayed near **280** PPM.	**280**
CO_2 above **350** PPM is not compatible with the planet life is adapted to.	**350**
Today the atmosphere is **420** PPM CO_2, rising about **2.5** PPM/year.	**420 / 2.5**
Human activity now dominates **50** % of Earth's land surface.	**50**
About **50%** of all fresh water is diverted to human use.	**50%**
"Limits to Growth" was published in **1972**, warning of consequences within **100** years.	**1972 / 100**

Activity B3

Match each report/event to its core message.

Item	Your match
Limits to Growth (1972)	Slowing the throughput of raw materials is needed to avoid breakdown
Hunger is not a Scourge but a Scandal (1974)	Hunger is caused by control of food by the rich, not by lack of land
NATURE state-shift (2012)	Human activity is pushing the biosphere toward a critical transition
Kiribati (2012)	An island nation seeking higher land due to sea-level rise

PART C Long-Answer Questions

Q1. Using the "Current Approach vs Work to be Done in Society" idea, explain why meeting population or water scarcity only with technology is symptomatic relief. What does an all-encompassing solution (Samadhan) require?

Meeting population or water scarcity only with technology is symptomatic relief because it treats the symptoms (e.g., low water supply) without addressing the root causes, such as overconsumption, inequitable distribution, and lack of harmony in human relationships. An all-encompassing solution (Samadhan) requires a holistic transformation that includes changes in human values, education, lifestyle, and relationships — both among humans and with nature — rather than relying solely on technological fixes.

Q2. Using the Problems table, describe how problems in the human–human relationship and in the human–rest-of-nature relationship are connected to the same root.

Problems in the human–human relationship (e.g., depression, suicide, terrorism, divorce, war) and in the human–rest-of-nature relationship (e.g., climate change, water insecurity, soil fertility loss, food insecurity) are connected to the same root: the lack of harmony and right understanding within individuals and society. Both sets of problems stem from selfishness, greed, and apathy — a worldview that prioritizes unlimited material consumption and competition over cooperation, sustainability, and respect for all life.

Q3. The slides note that the top environmental problems are "selfishness, greed and apathy… and we scientists don't know how to do that." In your own words, why does the solution call for human education rather than technology alone?

Technology alone cannot solve environmental problems because the root causes are not technical but human — selfishness, greed, and apathy drive overconsumption and exploitation. Human education is needed to transform values, awareness, and behavior, fostering a sense of responsibility, empathy, and harmony with nature. Without this inner change, technology will only be used to continue the same destructive patterns more efficiently.

Self-Reflection (Take-Home)

List three things in your own daily life that add to the human–rest-of-nature problems, and one change you can begin this week. / Watch "The Indoor Generation" (referenced in the deck) and note one way modern living has distanced you from nature.

Three things in my daily life that add to human–rest-of-nature problems: 1) Using single-use plastic packaging for snacks and drinks. 2) Leaving lights and electronics on when not in use, wasting electricity. 3) Eating food that is imported from far away, increasing carbon footprint. One change I can begin this week: Carry a reusable water bottle and refuse single-use plastic bags. One way modern living has distanced me from nature: I spend most of my day indoors in air-conditioned rooms and rarely feel the natural temperature, wind, or soil under my feet, losing connection to the seasons and the earth.